

Hurrah to contests!

Hi Vinit!

Contests! Contests! And more contests! What are the chances of winning? What are the (realistic) odds? Considering that this 'carnival' is going to be a quarterly affair, I wonder if readers get to choose what contest giveaways they'd like to see, or have... If so, and if you're open to suggestions on this subject, how about a contest that gives away free copies of 3ds max 5 + Combustion, or even Maya (or something cheaper)... Should entice interest amongst the pixel folk, no doubt.

Natraj Jayaraman

Via e-mail

Dear Digit Team,

I was just waiting for the pie and you gave it. The lots of Play and win Contests. I really love it all. Thanks for making my dreams come True. With Love.

Jacob Das

Via e-mail

Hi Natraj and Jacob,

We're glad you love all these contests. We've got around 6,500 responses. What are your chances of winning? Simple! You'll just have to be luckier than the others. And we do have plans to give away software. Price is no factor; we're just waiting for some large-hearted sponsors. If you have someone in mind, do let us know. And watch out for another contest carnival this June!

digit

Show me the security!

Dear Vinit,

After checking out some spy software that can log every key press I make, I'm paranoid about using public computers at a cyber-café or allowing anyone to use my computer as someone might install such software and hack my Internet banking passwords. Even though there are detection tools available for such Trojans, how do I ensure that these scanners are installed on every machine I use?

Vijay Vatyani

Via e-mail



Dear Vijay,

Security and privacy are big concerns for almost every computer user and paranoia on this front might not be such a bad thing after all. An extremist will tell you that everything we do can or is being watched at all times. However there are a few things that we can do to circumvent being spied upon: Install a personal firewall on your home PC to filter all outgoing network traffic, always update your anti-virus software, use strong passwords and never click on any unfamiliar e-mail attachments. Also, refrain from engaging in any online activity on public computers if the information you are accessing is sensitive in nature (online banking, shopping, etc).

Remember, in the U.S. a company has the legal right to monitor and observe all their employees in any job-related place or function. Sounds scary, doesn't it?

digit

Shattering myths

Hi Vinit,

Even though Digit gave the AMD Athlon XP 1700+ the Best Value award in February 2003, my hardware vendor insists that AMD processors need an air-conditioned room to operate or they get burnt out really fast. He mentions that these processors are not suitable for use in typical Indian conditions and recommends that I opt for a Pentium 4 1.7GHz instead.

Siddharth Utsav

Via e-mail

Hi Vinit,

I have heard that some games and other software might not run on an AMD based system. Is it true that most developers designed their software keeping an Intel Pentium processor in mind? Please suggest whether I should invest in an AMD processor?

Chetan Gupta

Via e-mail

Hi Siddharth and Chetan,

You can safely purchase AMD CPUs without worrying about compatibility issues. While some games and applications might be optimised for Intel CPUs, the fact remains that they will run on any x86-compatible processor (AMD processors are fully x86-compatible and can also make use of some of the Pentium optimisations). As far as heat generation is concerned, this is a common problem with the latest CPUs and you are advised to use a vendor recommended heat sink and fan; most of the time the problem lies with the incorrect installation of these cooling devices so I'd recommend getting your CPU professionally installed. Also ensure that you don't skimp on your system's power supply unit and pick up at least a 350 Watt SMPS.

digit

digit READERPOLLS

Q. Are you satisfied with the current packaging of Digit?

Yes	No
48%	52%

We welcome and encourage suggestions on how to improve the Digit packaging. E-mail them to readersletters@jasubhai.com.

Your vote counts

This month's question:

Question: Which anti-virus software do you use?

Choice of Answers (for Web site only)

☐ Norton ☐ McAfee ☐ AVG ☐ PC Cillin

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote on it